

Parish News

Kington, Huntington & Titley

February 2026

£1

THE KINGTON PARISHES



**St Mary, Kington; St Thomas a Becket, Huntington
St Stephen, Old Radnor; St Mary, Kinnerton; St Peter, Titley**
www.kingtonparishes.org.uk

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Cover: Snowdrops : Paul Roberts

From our Vicar

'Then I saw a new heaven and a new earth' (Revelation 21:1)

As I write, a thin layer of snow covers the ground. The paths are frosty and the roads are treacherous. The seasons of Christmas and Epiphany are over and Candlemas has brought with it a turning away from the birth of Christ towards the austerity of Lent and the dark purple of repentance.

We live in 'between-times'. The old order has passed away and the new one has arrived – but not yet. Our world is still wrapped in the grave-clothes of sin and wickedness; destruction and corruption still pollute God's creation. It is easy to despair when we hear the news which seems to be only of darkness and death on all fronts. It is easy to despair when we witness the fear and sadness of so many people in so many places. Hope might seem to have disappeared, becoming merely a memory, a glimpse dimly perceived. Then it may be that we need to leave our homes, our offices, our 'inside' places and look beyond ourselves to the glory of creation that surrounds us. .

Although it is bitterly cold outside, the sky is a beautiful bright blue, the sun is making the ice sparkle and catkins hang bravely on the trees. By the time this article is printed, snowdrops and cyclamen will have emerged from their cold darkness, giving us a glimpse of spring and a sign of hope. Even a bunch of flowers, or a scattering of seeds in a window box can show us the promise of new life and bring us hope once more.

Let us, this Lent, prepare for Easter not just with a shedding of bad habits or harmful behaviours, but with a spirit of readiness for new life and hope.



***'Our Lord
has written
the promise of
resurrection, not in
books alone,
but in every leaf in springtime.'***

(Martin Luther)

Sally

A Lent Course on Prayer

Lent is a season for drawing closer to God. This five-week course offers a gentle, supportive space to explore different ways to pray and grow in confidence and depth.

25th February – 25th March

Wednesdays, 7.00–8.00 pm

Venue: The Parish Hall

Everyone is welcome – no previous experience needed.

For further details,
contact

vicar@kingtonparishes.org.uk

St. Mary's Church, Kington

As I write this we are expecting heavy snow tomorrow in Kington and the surrounding villages. We hope you enjoyed any snow we had, tobogganing, throwing snowballs, walking, or staying inside keeping warm and looking at the changed landscape, depending upon age and your thoughts on such weather...

Perhaps there will be some snowdrops in bloom by the time your magazine arrives.

Memory tree

It will seem like a long while ago, but St Mary's eventually sent a total of £416 to St Michael's Hospice for the sale of stars – thank you all for your generosity.

Crib Festival

Also many thanks to everyone, including Year 7 at Lady Hawkins' School, who made a crib for the festival, which were greatly enjoyed by all who came to look at them.

Beetle Drives

After a break in January, these are resuming on February 3rd at 7pm in the Parish Hall, and we look forward to seeing you there. If you have never been to a Beetle drive, do come along – great fun, absolutely no skill required, prizes to be won, and tea/coffee/ biscuits, all for £5.

Stay and Play

Every Tuesday during term time, 9.15 to 10.45, at the Parish Hall. Stories, songs, toys, craft and refreshments for parents/carers and children 0 – 3yrs. Come along and have some fun!



Pancakes galore Holiday Club.

This will be held on February 17th, 1.30 to 4pm at St Mary's, with refreshments afterwards. Children under 5 must be accompanied. Booking essential, £5 per child (concessions available).

Do come and join in with the fun.

Wild Church

This is a new venture for St Mary's. Come and join us in exploring the great outdoors, using proven forest school techniques. Beginning on 8th March, from 2.30 to 4pm. Venue to be confirmed later.

Lego Club

As usual, from 3.30 in St. Mary's, on 18th February and 18th March.

Good Friday Holiday Club

Advance notice, 3rd April at St. Mary's, 9.30 to 11.30. Do save the date!

We do hope you will be able to join us with some of our activities and look forward to seeing you sometime. We also hope you are keeping warm this winter and enjoy the beginning of spring when it and the snowdrops arrive!

With best wishes from us both,

Ann Edwards and Margaret Cooke
Churchwardens

Forthcoming Activities for Children and Families at St Mary's

17/02/26. Pancakes galore Holiday Club

Children under 5 must be accompanied. Booking essential £5 per child, concessions available. St Mary's Church, 1:30-4pm with refreshments afterwards

18/02/26 Lego Club

St Mary's Church, 3.30pm

08/03/26 Wild Church.

Come and explore the great outdoors using proven forest school techniques. 2:30-4.00pm
(location to be confirmed)

18/03/26 Lego Club

St Mary's Church, 3.30pm

03/04/26 Good Friday Holiday Club

Children under 5 must be accompanied. Booking essential £5 per child, concessions available. St Mary's Church, 9:30-11.30 with refreshments afterwards

12/04/26 Wild Church

Come and explore the great outdoors using proven forest school techniques. 2:30-4.00pm
(location to be confirmed)

Stay and Play

Every Tuesday during term time from 13th January, 9:15-10:45am at
the Parish Hall (parking at rear).

Stories, songs, toys, craft and refreshments for parents/ carers and
children 0-3.

Why not come and have some fun!

Treasurer

St Mary's needs a new treasurer to replace Nick, who retires at the next Annual Parochial Church Meeting in April. The bookkeeping is done by our bookkeeper, Mark North, who maintains the spreadsheets and produces the accounts which accompany the annual report. Please contact Nick (07846 430111 or st.marys.kington.treasurer@gmail.com) if you are interested.

St Thomas a Becket, Huntington

Mrs Bertha Morgan (Huntington School Headmistress 1911-1953 – continued:

Children attended school from a considerably wide area around Huntington, with 80 children on the school Register in 1887.

In April 1911 Rev. D J Morgan became Congregational Minister for Huntington and Gore. Three years later he married Bertha (26/02/1917) at Huntington. They had two daughters – Dorothy and Hilda.

Bertha was very musical and taught children to play the piano, also training some for the Royal Academy of Music exams.

Huntington School became an examination centre for the Royal College of Music.

Despite attempts to place the school under the Local Education Authority, there were insufficient funds to bring the premises up to the required standard. Therefore, the Trustees maintained the school's independence, meaning staff had to accept much lower salaries than those offered at a State school.

In 1926 Emily Inseal (from Bungy's Head), came to work for Bertha, starting at 7:00am every day (except Sunday) to work either indoors, in the garden, or on the smallholding. She worked there until Bertha left in 1954.

Piped water was installed at Huntington School and house in 1927. One man dug a trench by hand from Well Green, through Penland Piece and through the school yards. Work was completed in 1931, when a bathroom and running water in the kitchen and school was installed.

In 1928 Mrs C D Edwards (Huntington Court), formed a Women's Institute, with the opening ceremony performed by Lady Arkwright. Mrs

Edwards became the first President and Bertha Morgan te first Secretary.

On 25/03/1938, John and Bertha were interviewed from the Birmingham Studios for a 20 minute "Border Community Broadcast", reflecting on their personal and working



life in a rural community. The booklet "Schoolmistress at Huntington – The Life of Bertha Morgan" includes a verbatim account of the interview.

In October 1949, Bertha's husband died aged 72. He had been Minister at Huntington and Gore for almost 38 years. Bertha remained School Headmistress, but in 1953, was told it was time to retire. As there were insufficient funds to improve conditions at the school, or to pay realistic salaries, the Trustees were forced to close the school.

Bertha had a severe stroke in 1954, forcing her to leave Huntington to live alternatively with her two daughters (Hilda's in Coventry and Dorothy's in Woking). The home at Huntington had been continuously in the family for 92 years. Bertha had a second stroke in 1959, and died shortly afterwards aged 83.

Reference from "Schoolmistress at Huntington – The Life of Bertha Morgan" by Hilda Kendall – ISBN 0 9517478 0 0

Carol Singers:

The usual group of village carol singers, made their pre-Christmas visit to numerous homes in Huntington singing carols and bringing Christmas cheer. Households were extremely generous and the £207 raised has been donated to Kington Surgery Patient Participation Group.

Village Hall - Quiz Night – Saturday 28 February – 7:30 start:

This is always a popular event, so do come along and join in the fun.

Susan Maiden

PARISH NEWS PRICES FOR 2026

Sale Prices

The new prices for copies of the Kington, Huntington and Titley Parish News are:

Single copies £1. This is unchanged.

Subscription for the year: £10. An increase but still cheaper than single copies.

– Advertising

The advertising year is from April to March, 12 Copies. The new prices are:

Full page: £340

Half page: £190

Quarter page: £100

Eighth page: £50

Based on an A5 page size.

Further information from Nick:
st.marys.kington.treasurer@gmail.com,
01544 230805



St. Peter's Church Titley

Readers

Sunday 1st February Dick.

Sunday 15th February Elizabeth.

Church Lighting.

I have received many comments saying how lovely the church has looked over Christmas with it illuminated for a few hours at night.

Sadly, on three occasions the lights have been deliberately turned off causing much discontent. I have now padlocked the plug box and if the lights are turned off now the plug box or the padlocks would have to be damaged. This would constitute a criminal offence of Criminal Damage, and I know the PCC would support a police prosecution. As I have said before, if whoever keeps turning them off comes and speaks to me about it, we may be able to resolve the situation.

Parish Magazine

It's that time of the year when the magazine subscriptions are due. This year it is £10. Please either drop it into Pam at the Grapevine or leave it in an envelope with your name on it at my home.

There are some people who still owe for last year. If you are one of them, please pay for the two years before you are "Named and Shamed"!!

Many thanks

Dick

Kington Parishes: February 2026

Sunday, 1st Candlemass

1 Kings 17:8-16, Psalm 36:5-10, 1 Corinthians 1:18-end, John 2:1-11

10.00am:	Holy Communion:	Titley
10.00am:	Holy Communion*:	Kington
11.30am:	Holy Communion:	Kinnerton
6.00pm:	Junior Praise:	Old Radnor
6.00pm	Praise and Prayer Evening:	Kington

Sunday, 8th 2 Before Lent

Genesis 1:1-23, Psalm 136, Romans 8:18-25, Matthew 6:25-end

8.30am:	Holy Communion:	Huntington
10.00am:	Holy Communion*:	Kington
11.30am:	Holy Eucharist:	Old Radnor
6.00pm:	Evening Prayer:	Kinnerton

Sunday, 15th Sunday next before Lent

Exodus 24:12-end, Psalm 2, 2 Peter 1:16-end, Matthew 17:1-9

10.00am:	Holy Communion:	Titley
10.00am:	Morning Praise*:	Kington
6.00pm:	Evening Prayer:	Old Radnor

Wednesday 18th Ash Wednesday

Joel 2: 1-2, 12-17, Psalm 51. 1-18, 2 Corinthians 5: 20b-6:10

Matthew 6:1-6, 16-21

7.00pm	Holy Communion and Imposition of Ashes	Kington
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Sunday, 22nd First Sunday of Lent

Genesis 2:15-17, 3:1-7, Psalm 32, Romans 5:12-19, Matthew 4:1-11

10.00am:	Holy Eucharist*:	Kington
6.00pm:	Evening Prayer:	Kinnerton
6.00pm	Evensong:	Huntington

*** Live streamed services**

Heating St Mary's

An explanation.

Why can't we turn up the heating?

- Heating is limited because of the size of the cabling that goes underground to the church.
- There are automatic controls on the system to prevent our blowing the main fuses.

What does this mean?

- The nave has three pairs of halos which are operated by three controls.
- We can have two pairs at full power or three pairs at reduced power. At the time of writing we had been running three pairs at reduced power. We are about to run an experiment: we will turn the front halos on full and the back ones off. This is what we will have told the congregation:
 - The warmest areas will be in the front pews away from the pillars and under the Halos. The back pews will not be heated unless the front pews become full. It may mean that you must break the habit of an Anglican lifetime and sit somewhere different. And wear as many thick clothes as you reasonably can.
 - AND SIT IN THE FRONT PEWS UNDER A HEATER (The people close to you will help to keep you warm!)
 - We repeat: THE BACK PEWS WILL NOT BE HEATED!! For the duration of this experiment.
- We will have asked the congregation for feedback.

Couldn't we upgrade the power supply to get more heat?

That may have cost more than £100,000, require digging a trench across the path and down the church yard. It could require rewiring what we have just installed.

Could we have chosen to stay with the gas heating and be warmer?

No

Why not?

1. There are financial reasons. In the past, the gas heating was costing about £10,000 per year to run. With inflation that would now be close to £15,000. We cannot afford this.
2. The standing charge for the gas supply is a bit less than £2,000 per year. The standing charge for the electrical supply is unchanged with the new system. So we save £2,000 a year by not having a gas supply.
3. There are Church of England rules: Just before we finished installing the new system the boiler broke down and would have required replacing. The Church of England has ruled that we must become net zero CO₂ by 2030 – no new gas boilers.
4. Even if the boiler had not broken down, in four years' time we would not have been allowed to continue using it.

Why is the new system the best that we could have?

1. As a witness to our care for God's gift of our beautiful planet we must cut our carbon footprint as far as possible.
2. It means that when our grandchildren are suffering the consequences of the overuse of fossil fuels in terms of pollution and global warming we can say that we did our best.
3. It is highly economical in terms of maintenance and energy costs.
4. It gives future generations flexibility in terms of the arrangements of pews.
5. It is what we could afford.

Nick Cooke

8th January 2026

God by Numbers

2 Two copper coins placed in the offering by a widow were of greater value than the gold shekels thrown in by the rich. Jesus noted this selfless gift poured out from a widow's heart. She could have kept one, but gave two. According to Solomon's wisdom (Ecclesiastes 4:9-13), two is better than one. Alas he didn't stick to that one; his many wives were his downfall. The beginning of Genesis tells us it wasn't good for Adam to be alone. He named a host of living creatures brought before him, but it was Eve, also made in God's image, who became his partner. Adam and Eve, the two, became one for the joy of filling the earth with a myriad of ones made in God's image. It was two by two that the ark was filled and mankind was rescued.

Thomas, a twin, missed the resurrected Jesus when he first appeared to the hiding disciples. He greeted their astounding reports with doubt (duo-mindedness) and scepticism. To him it was all over and wishful foolishness to think otherwise. Then Jesus came to him. On seeing the risen Lord, Thomas fell to his knees and cried out, "My Lord and my God". Thomas of two minds gives us hope; he saw the Lord full of forgiveness, and became wholehearted and single minded as a receiver of God's love.

I wonder if the two thieves crucified with Jesus also provide encouragement. One thief sneered, but the second rebuked the first, saying to Jesus "remember me when you come into your kingdom". Jesus replied "Truly, I say to you, today you will be with me in paradise". When Jesus cried out and breathed his last, the great temple curtain was torn in two from top to bottom. The temple and the priesthood were rendered redundant. The Centurion standing at the foot of the cross declared "Truly this man was the Son of God". The two of them believed, soldier and thief.

Robert MacCurrach and David Stearns

Our Relationship with God gives us our Identity

The 2020s has been the decade of identity. Suddenly everyone had to add gender pronouns to their email signatures. However, in God's kingdom our identity comes only from our relationship with him.

So in Christ Jesus you are all children of God through faith, for all of you who were baptised into Christ have clothed yourselves with Christ. There is neither Jew nor Gentile, neither slave nor free, nor is there male and female, for you are all one in Christ Jesus. If you belong to Christ, then you are Abraham's seed, and heirs according to the promise.

Galatians 3:26-29

We identify only as Children of God. I honestly do not care about your past, your denomination, your sexuality, your trans/cis status, your pronouns, your politics. What I do care about deeply is your future, whether or not you are a Child of God, adopted into His family and loving Him with all your heart. That does not mean that we don't have to deal with past sins, mistakes and hurts. With God's help, we certainly do have to do that. But when we are a new creation, the old has gone and the new has come. Our lives are now on a different trajectory. Satan will remind you of your past (you can remind him of his future!). Sometimes he will even use Christians to do that. Focus on loving God, everything else will fall into place. Your identity is no longer in your past. Your identity is in your eternal future as a Child of God.

Greg Wright

Reader Writes

Just past the winter solstice, thankfully our earth and only home has tilted quite far enough from the warming sun. The glare in your eyes makes drivers and cyclists long for some January mirk. Temperatures go up; so mild. Then they plummet and you hunt for a thicker jumper. But we know all this from what the birds are doing. I listen for the drumming of great spotted woodpeckers as I cycle up the more wooded lanes; milder conditions bring on competition for territories. Perhaps a favourite call of our ever so steadily changing season is the woo-wooning of the shy stock dove; they waste no time in taking possession of a favourite nesting hole in an old tree. Everyone wants those!

There is pleasing allegory in the signs of spring in the middle of winter. The world may look wet and cold, but a walk and a little attention reveal so much more going on than you might think. As dead leaves heap up and begin to rot, and the bare trees shake, suddenly there seems to be new life advancing, perhaps quietly, modestly. Bulbs are pushing up. Leaf and flower buds are fattening. Trees, on closer inspection, are burnished with new life. Hence the allegory; when all is decay you suddenly notice new life bursting from the wreckage of the old. And it's there in every season. Thank you for winter scented shrubs that stop you in your track, or spring flowers jostling for the sun while they can.

Hope is one of those spiritual gifts that the early spring invites us to celebrate. Hope is an anchor for our soul, not a kite on a string

that bends and turns with the wind's every impulse. The Apostle Paul teaches us the key nature of hope in his letter to the Thessalonian church. "We continually remember before our God and Father your work produced by faith, your labour prompted by love, and your endurance inspired by hope in our Lord Jesus Christ." Love, faith and hope go together; hope cannot exist without faith, and love cannot be exercised without hope.

Those who dare look up see a very troubling world. I'm vaguely conscious of the mesmerising popularity of Strictly! But at the same time, how do you avoid the guilt and anger normal people would feel when

they see Gaza and Ukraine and Sudan? When the real world of suffering and injustice exists alongside the comprehensible and accepted world of western trivia, where does a Christian turn? Silently, on our knees? Get arrested on the barricades?

However we feel about the world, this is the season of new growth and promise. We can turn to God with gratitude, just saying thank you. We can weep for the victims of appalling

injustice; no need to look beyond even our own communities. That's how our world works until our Lord comes again. As we walk in the early spring air, or even just hearing the growing dawn chorus through an open window, we are reminded that hope is an anchor amid hopelessness. We can rejoice that those bursting buds, delightful hellebores, the sweet song of the dunnock from the bottom of a dripping hedge, all spell the certainty of hope in our God who created all this dear life.

Robert MacCurrach

Love, faith and hope go together; hope cannot exist without faith, and love cannot be exercised without hope

Caring for God's Acre

Spring Messenger

As winter starts to draw to a close and the days are getting noticeably longer we all start to search for signs of spring. One of the first spring flowers is the Lesser Celandine. This little plant, often viewed as a garden weed, lights up our churchyards with bright, shiny, yellow stars set off beautifully by the surrounding dark green heart-shaped leaves. An old name for Lesser Celandine was 'Spring Messenger' and, like the Snowdrop, it can lift the spirits with the message that spring is coming.

Another old name is Pilewort, suggesting that this plant was used to treat haemorrhoids. Richard Maybey in his *Flora Britannica* considers this prescription to have been due to the Doctrine of Signatures, a belief that similar shaped plants could cure specific ills. In the case of Lesser Celandine it is the knobbly tubers that were thought to resemble piles!

Lesser Celandine is a common plant which can spread fast and likes shady damp areas, but it is not fussy and can be found in grassland, at the base of walls or monuments, on banks, verges and along path edges and is always to be found within churchyards, chapel yards and cemeteries. The cheerful yellow flowers can carpet the ground offering an important early nectar supply to emerging insects such as queen bumblebees, beetles and other pollinators.

Although small, the Lesser Celandine has attracted the attention of the famous. Wordsworth wrote three poems about it and the naturalist Gilbert White of Selborne in Hampshire recorded when he saw his first Lesser Celandine each year, the average date being the 21st February. This date has been known as Celandine Day since 1795. Now, due to climate change, the flowers can be seen earlier in the year with some coming into bloom in late January.

Enjoy the Lesser Celandine in February, its



flowers and leaves both die back in late spring so please make a record of it using iNaturalist, as anyone looking at plants later in the year may not find any remaining traces of it so it can easily go unrecorded. Although a common plant it is an important one and one on which our early pollinators rely.

All the best,

Harriet Carty

Diocesan Churchyard Environmental Advisor



– Kington Creations –

St Mary's Lego Club

Thousands of bricks, Lots of mini figures,
Loads of fun !

Wednesday 18th February

3:30pm – 5:00pm

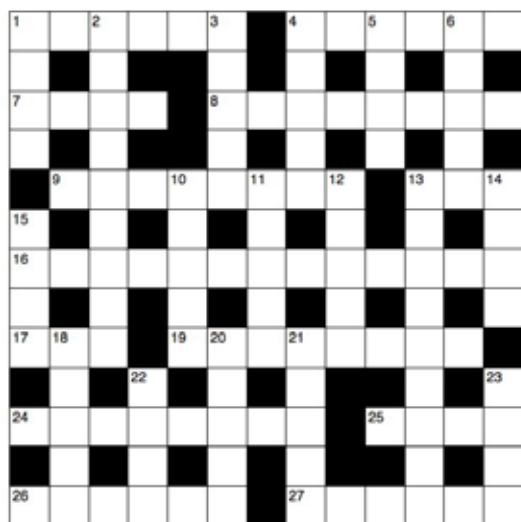
St Marys Church Kington

Young children to be accompanied
by an adult please

Refreshments available
legoclub.kington@gmail.com

Having fun creating together

February Crossword



Across

- 1 'If you love those who love you, what — is that to you?' (Luke 6:32) (6)
- 4 'They threw the ship's — overboard' (Acts 27:19) (6)
- 7 The first murderer (Genesis 4:8) (4)
- 8 He was the head Levite in charge of the singing when the ark of God was brought back to Jerusalem (1 Chronicles 15:22) (8)
- 9 Samson was noted for this (Judges 16:6) (8)
- 13 Solicit money or food from passers by (Acts 3:2) (3)
- 16 What William Booth's Christian Mission became in 1878 (9,4)
- 17 Alliance of Religions and Conservation (1,1,1)
- 19 'I will praise your name for ever and ever. — I will praise you' (Psalm 145:1-2) (5,3)
- 24 Simon had (anag.) (8)
- 25 Desperate (Deuteronomy 28:48) (4)
- 26 Elisha witnessed the boy he was seeking to resuscitate do this seven times before opening his eyes (2 Kings 4:35) (6)
- 27 The belly and thighs of the statue in Nebuchadnezzar's dream were made of this (Daniel 2:32) (6)

Down

- 1 'Before the — crows, you will disown me three times' (Matthew 26:75) (4)
- 2 Relating to the books of the Bible between Acts and Revelation (9)
- 3 'They have — the Lord out of the tomb, and we don't know where they have put him!' (John 20:2) (5)
- 4 Belief (5)
- 5 'Take the following fine spices: ... 250 shekels of fragrant — ' (Exodus 30:23) (4)
- 6 'Do not — Jerusalem, but wait for the gift' (Acts 1:4) (5)
- 10 A seer (anag.) (5)
- 11 'Even there your hand will — me' (Psalm 139:10) (5)
- 12 The wild variety was part of John the Baptist's diet (Mark 1:6) (5)
- 13 A non-Greek speaker who was looked down on by civilized people (Colossians 3:11) (9)
- 14 Famous 1950s musical whose characters included members of
- 16 Across, — and Dolls (4)
- 15 The province from which Paul wrote to the Corinthians (1 Corinthians 16:19) (4)
- 18 'He was standing in the gateway with a linen cord and a measuring — his hand' (Ezekiel 40:3) (3,2)
- 20 'Today, if you hear his —, do not harden your hearts as you did in the rebellion' (Hebrews 3:15) (5)
- 21 The Jericho prostitute who hid two Israelite spies on the roof of her house (Hebrews 11:31) (5)
- 22 'And now these three remain: faith, — and love. But the greatest of these is love' (1 Corinthians 13:13) (4)
- 23 'God has numbered the days of your reign and brought it to an end' (Daniel 5:26) (4)

Please see page 20 for answers

MONTHLY MUSINGS

“Upon my **soul!**” she cried. “Upon your what?” “Upon my **soul!**” And what’s that? What is your soul? What is my soul? - or simply – **What does the word SOUL mean to you?** That’s what I’ve been musing about these past few weeks.

Looking it up in the dictionary just led me into confusion.

Even my biblical dictionary wasn’t much help, except that it suggested that in the Old Testament the word was used mostly as an alternative for person. We might use it like

this ourselves sometimes, when we refer colloquially to a suffering person as a poor soul. In N.T. times the Greek word used for soul is psyche which is the abstract material stuff, source of the body’s life. It also means personality, making you, you.

So I’ve come to think of the soul as what’s left over when all the rest of me is gone! It’s a sort of living-in companion, a friend, a wise adviser. It’s my true self, which, like Mary’s soul, *magnifies the Lord and rejoices in God*

my Saviour. A friend of ours who practises healing, refers to her work as taking place in her **soul space**. Perhaps that describes it quite well. A space, not a physical part of us, not like our heart or our brain.

The seventeenth century poet, Henry Vaughan, wrote what you might call an anti-war poem that starts, “My soul there is

a country far beyond the stars.”

It’s a favourite anthem of mine and has also been set as a hymn (A&M No 735). The words suggest to me that in Vaughan’s soul space, his spiritual companion was experiencing an amazing vision of this distant country where war is no more and *there grows the flower of peace*. If only!

For me, music can be a wonderful and healing inspiration for the soul, even for those obsessed, for instance, with double decker buses! Only yesterday at lunch, in order to be spared the constant expression of that obsession, we were able to trump it by switching on the glorious music from Vienna’s New Year’s Day concert. Knife and fork immediately became conductor’s baton – in between mouthfuls – hallelujah!

Denis

A space, not a physical part of us, not like our heart or our brain

DEADLINE MARCH EDITION

Please note that the deadline for the March edition of Kington Parish News will be

Sunday February 1st. The editors have a very tight deadline to get the magazine to the printers and anything arriving after the 1st will be held over for the April edition.

May we also ask that any submissions should be 500 words MAXIMUM for all editions. We have to juggle so many items – which is great, but even exceeding the words count by 20 words means someone else’s copy may not be able to be fitted. Please do not be offended if copy that exceeds the 500-word count is returned for pruning!!

Thanks for your continued support and cooperation.

Craig and David



Saturday

14th February, 7.30pm
Music in New Radnor

***Trio Sonoro 'A Time
 Traveller's Pilgrimage'***

Deborah Catterall – mezzo-soprano,
 Gareth Glyn Roberts – tenor,
 Richard MacKenzie – lute.

Early music lovers - take note. This concert is an adventure in musical history as we travel through time with our pilgrim. This musical journey will take us from the 9th to the 17th century via the music of Josquin des Pres, Guillaume Du Fay, Francesco Landini, William Byrd and a host of other early composers.

This promises to be an evening of captivating and entertaining early songs from two eminent singers, interspersed with lute solos by a master of the instrument. Trio Sonoro will explain the programme, translate the texts and explore 'hopping off' points through the musical journey. They describe the programme a 'a mixture of beautiful, humorous, romantic – and just plain fun at times'.

New Radnor Community Hall,
 Hall Lane, New Radnor, Powys, LD8 2SW
 Pre-booking preferred if possible
 Tickets £15 (under 14s, £3) from
 01544 350746 or 07493 940683
 Doors open at 7pm for a 7.30 start.

Wordsearch

P B P Y O D E I B P N N M G
 T N W F R M L S I A N I H R
 W T L E T A P R P F B S N S
 T W T S N D M P O S I Y A F
 N F N T A G E R A W D M I A
 A N O I T A T N E S E R P V
 D E C V R Y N J L L S H L R
 A E A A O T E T D T C Y I I
 B T N L P P M N N H R L G T
 S C D D M S A M T S I R H C
 E E L B I C T P J G B A T I
 S W E Y E A S A H O E E I B
 A W S Y A D E T Y N D F N A
 P U B L I C T I Y G C I G G

The Presentation of Christ in the Temple/Candlemas

Candlemas, 2nd February, comes exactly 40 days after Christmas. In New Testament times 40 days old was an important age for a baby boy: it was when they made their first 'public appearance'. Mary, like all good Jewish mothers, went to the Temple with Jesus, her first male child - to 'present Him to the Lord'. Thus, we have the Festival of the Presentation of Christ in the Temple (Luke 2: 22-40).

So where does the Candlemas bit come in? Jesus is described in the New Testament as the Light of the World, and early Christians developed the tradition of lighting many candles in celebration of this day.

Candlemas	Baby	Presentation
Forty	Boy	Described
Days	First	Light
After	Public	World
Christmas	Appearance	Candles
New	Mary	Lighting
Testament	Jewish	Early
Important	Temple	
Age	Festival	

Please see page 20 for answers

News From the Museum

Silver John

Do you remember the Drew Family of Lyonshall? Eddie and his mother before him were renowned bone setters, very much sort after for their services. Before the Drews in the late 1700's, was a John Lloyd living on a sheep farm in Radnor Forest.,

John had the gift for bone setting using splints and bandaging together, using this method when finding injured lambs and sheep with broken legs. To help the healing he would brew herbs which some had antiseptic properties. John reputation grew and was much sought after for healing animals, but a local millers son broke his leg, asking John if he would use his skills to help his son, which was very successful. The miller offered John some coins for

his help, but John refusing said he, would accept "a silver thanks offering". He received two silver buttons and so began a legend. "Silver John, the bone-setter".

John acquired a waistcoat, also an overcoat each covered with silver buttons, which son John took great pride in polishing. Some payments were more valuable than buttons. From Sir William de Breos of Tomen Castle pair of silver buckles for mending a broken ankle, another gift of a silver snuff box, also a heavy silver-knobbed stick which went everywhere with him. Eventually the coat looked like shining armour, worn on special occasions, when attending broken bones or in Builth Market on business. Attending Builth Michaelmas

Fair in his Gambo, completing his business, set off for home in the dark. At Llyn Hylin, the horse and Gambo were found at the farm gate next morning without John. Where was John? After searching, no sign was found he had completely disappeared.

In January, known as the Great Frost, Radnor Candlemas Fair was to be held on Llyn Hilyin lake, frozen solid right to the bottom. Fires were light around the edge of the lake enabling people to skate or play games on the ice, with mulled cider and cakes available. The daughter of Landlord of the Forest Inn, slipped on the ice landing on her face. She gave a pricing scream, pointing down into the ice. They looked and to everyone horror appeared the

face of an old man, apparently sleeping, completely preserved. It was Silver John.

The festivities came to a halt and discussing on what to do next. Did they break the ice and recover the body or wait for the thaw. The frozen state would probably break his bones meaning his spirit would not rest.

On a warm spring day John's body was gently lifted from the lake. Gone was all his silver. John had been murdered.

John was taken to Harley Dingle, burying him on the slopes of the Great Craigau.

His murderers were never found but a doggerel was written:

*"Silver John is dead and gone,
So they came home a singing,
Radnor boys pulled out his eyes
And set the bells a-ringing."*

It is known that descendants of John Lloyd still practice this skill on animals.

Wendy Jones

**The frozen state
would probably
break his bones
meaning his spirit
would not rest.**

Not a Proper Gardener (Part 61)

One of the benefits of being not a proper gardener is that, if the weather is inclement or you just don't feel like it, you can simply slack off, which is what has happened recently to me. Apart from Emma's bit of input, the jungle has simply had to look after itself. And that's in some ways quite good for it. A bit of frosty weather, unless you have any very delicate plants, is favourable, nature's way of cleansing things up a little and giving the soil a rest.

Nevertheless, we are still able to harvest some greenstuff, salads and roots. For example, for our high tea on Christmas Day we had lovely fresh salad from the greenhouse, beetroot from under its duvet outdoors and the last of the fresh tomatoes ripened from a sunny windowsill indoors.

Emma has been struggling with the pond, trying to trim the holly tree which overhangs it and to pull out some pernicious reeds which persist in reseeding in the wrong place. Otherwise, her chief tasks involve protecting the salads growing in the greenhouse and looking after all the dickybirds. I eventually got round to sowing those aguadulce broad beans in coir pots just before Christmas and now I have 40 healthy plants on my bedroom windowsills, ready to plant out under cloches as soon as this cold snap gives way a bit. The packet says they are extremely hardy. We shall see! We also must pot up the amaryllis that Giles gave me for Christmas.

An important task we undertake on January 17th, Old Twelfth Night, is to Wassail the trees, a traditional custom from Anglo-Saxon times designed to welcome in good spirits to keep them productive and in good health. Wassail means Be well, and there's a little ceremony involving the giving to each tree a sprinkle of mulled cider and a handful of potash with a suitable blessing and thanksgiving.



This may all smack of paganism, but Christianity has accepted it along with the little song with which you may be familiar. Here's the first of its six verses as it used to be sung by poor children visiting neighbours:

The Wassail Song

Here we come a-wassailing
Among the leaves so green,
Here we come a-wand'ring So fair to be seen.
Love and joy come to you,
And to you your wassail, too,
And God bless you and send you a
Happy New Year,
And God send you a Happy New Year.

Happy gardening, Denis.

KINGTON COMMUNITY LUNCH CLUB

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We meet on the
3rd Wednesday of each month.

Next lunch is on 18th February

Contact: Chris 07990 288964

Brilley Flicks in the Sticks and live performance

Thursday 5th February at 7.30: Lee (12A), £5

Discover Elizabeth 'Lee' Miller (played by Kate Winslet), a fashion model and photographer who became an acclaimed war correspondent for Vogue magazine during World War II and who intrepidly and heroically documented the truth of the Nazi regime. Thursday 5th March at 7.30: Girls will be girls (15), £5 In a strict 1990s boarding school in the Himalayan foothills, model student Mira's first taste of love collides with her mother's buried desires, sparking a tender yet rebellious coming-of-age story.

Thursday 12th March at 7.30: Juliet & Romeo live performance, £12

With Lost Dog's blend of dance, theatre and comedy this Juliet & Romeo reveals the real story behind Shakespeare's famous lovers. It turns out they didn't die in a tragic misunderstanding; they grew up and lived happily ever after. Well, they lived at least. Now they're 40ish, at least one of them is in the grips of a mid-life crisis, they feel constantly mocked by their teenage selves and haunted by the pressures of being the poster couple for romantic love. They have decided to confront their current struggles by putting on a performance – about themselves. Their therapist told them it was a terrible idea.

Brilley and Michaelchurch Village Hall (HR3 6JG), doors open at 7pm. Don't forget to bring your own refreshments for flicks nights! Bar will be open for the Juliet & Romeo live performance.

As usual advance booking only - please book and pay for your tickets online at pay-brilley.co.uk

Easy Sudoku

1	9					5		8
	2	6		3	8	1		9
8				7		4		
				9				6
3	4		8		6		1	7
2				1				
		4		8				1
7		3	9	2		6	5	
6		2					8	3

Intermediate Sudoku

							7	2
					9	5		3
6	7			3	2	9		
9				1				
4	1	6				7	9	5
				6				1
		3	1	8			4	6
2		7	4					
8	4							

KINGTON TOWN
COUNCIL
UPDATE



Happy New Year to you all and we hope that 2026 is a positive year for the town and its residents.

Kington Town Council has a lot to look forward to over the coming months as we have previously reported and I now understand that listed building consent has been given on the market hall so we look forward to the repairs being undertaken soon. We hope many of you enjoyed the Christmas lights turn on event an event that the council is delighted to support and to continue lighting up the town over the Christmas

period. Our thanks go to the Chamber of trade for all their hard work in organising the event, One further win the council has achieved has been to get the footpaths and Church Street cleared of leaves. This has been an ongoing issue for many years, and we have finally persuaded Herefordshire council to carry out this very necessary work. We are hoping that we can now make this a regular occurrence and discussions are underway to achieve this. Finally, we are always pleased to receive any thoughts and observations you may have about the town and what you might like to see happen. We can't always guarantee success but can try and get your concerns to the right people.

Cllr Martin Woolford

Faith Believes

Lucy Mann would like to invite all those who participated in *'Peace Talks'* and *'Justice Roars'* events in Kington to a talk and discussion called *'Faith Believes'* on **Tuesday 10th February** at Kington Baptist Church.

Lucy's challenge for November was to walk from Nasareth in North Wales to Bethlehem in South Wales to raise awareness of the existence and resistance of Palestinian Christians in Israel and the West Bank. She called this challenge *'Humility Walks'*.

The discussion will include events that some people describe as 'incredible'. Please contact Lucy if you would like to join her in a future collaborative project called *'Peace Sings'*.

email: lucymann@gmail.com or
call 07963 198949

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From Lady Hawkins School

The pupils were asked to write a structured essay about New Year traditions. There were several interesting, well-written submissions. Of particular interest were the sections relating to the pupils' own traditions or resolutions. The script reproduced below (edited a little) is by Tristan (Yr 10). With thanks to Miss Moss for having work ready so early in the new term.

Long, long ago, the mighty Roman Empire had troubles. The year started around March, which didn't leave time for conquering and warring. Spring was the perfect time for this, so with the year ending just before war, how could they plan? The easy option: add two months to the start of the year and force all to adopt the new calendar.

I realise this article may be a little bit late for New Year, but New Year is celebrated at different times world wide! Some traditions in other countries are more eccentric (such as throwing a chair to throw the past away in South Africa), and some calmer (such as sending pretty, high explosives into the sky and saying, "Oooh").

In Spain, people eat 12 grapes at midnight under the table to bring luck in the New Year, while in Japan, temple bells ring their bells a lot, 108 times, to be exact, which must hurt your ears... Anyway, most traditions are old, and often symbolise new beginnings, reflection on the past, and the psychological phenomenon of a "fresh start". Back to the Romans. The month of January was created for a) more preparation and planning for conquests, and b) to honour Janus. Despite the unfortunate name, he was honoured for being able to see into the future and into the past, having two faces. As the Roman Empire was huge, this idea spread quickly, and eventually stuck, including some tweaks, with the year

ending on 31st December. Apart from in China, which missed the invite.

The Chinese calendar is based on the lunar cycle instead of the orbit of earth. The moon is very important to the Chinese, as they believe it to ward off bad luck and evil spirits, which is good.

While the traditions around the world differ, personal reflection is practised by almost all of us. For me, the New Year is a time to pause, help out and build back better around the house. The dogs and horses need bedding, ice needs to be smashed, logs chopped and burnt. But reflection on the self is key. This year I started writing poetry, and had a fresh perspective of the world and society. I won two awards from school (I bet you got excited for a young poet laureate, didn't you!), and inspired others to write too. I also managed to complete a long-time hiking challenge in the Black Mountains. But, enough about me. I hope your year was better than mine, and this one better yet. What does the New Year, January, and all the rest of it mean to you?

For all advertising enquiries please contact:
pn.kingtonparishes@gmail.com

OAK | Open Arms Kingston February events



Events and opening at The Oxford Arms, Kingston, February 2026.

Details for all events on our website (openarmskington.co.uk).

Tel: 07301081444, email info@openarmskington.co.uk.

FEBRUARY 2026

Wednesday 4th February, 10am-12.30pm. *Sunflower Social at Places of Welcome.* A hidden disabilities support group and network, meeting in The Oxford's barn on the first Wednesday of the month during our regular Places Of Welcome opening hours. Free.

Wednesday 11th February, 10am-12.30pm. *Dementia Matters at Places of Welcome.* Support group and network for people affected by dementia, meeting in The Oxford's barn on the second Wednesday of the month during our regular Places Of Welcome opening hours. Free.

Saturday 14th February, from 6pm. *Not-Valentine's Party.* For anyone who wants to escape Valentine's Day, we'll be hosting an alternative party! More details on our website. Free.

Sunday 22nd February, 2-4pm. *Creative Workshop at The Oxford Arms.* This month's activity is calligraphy! Payment by donation (suggested £5). Live 100 Club draw at 3pm, bar and cafe open 12-4pm.

Regular opening hours in February:

Places of Welcome at The Oxford Arms, every Wednesday morning 10am-12.30pm in February.

OAK | Open Arms Kingston CiC

www.openarmskington.co.uk

comms@openarmskington.co.uk

The Oxford Arms is open occasional Sundays over the winter; see our website for latest updates.

February

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Best wishes

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4-Feb Luctonians U-14 Rugby
South Africa Tour

11-Feb St Bede's Church

18-Feb Wales and Border Harness Racing

25-Feb Radnor and West Hereford Pony Club

Answers Page

Wordsearch



Crossword



Easy Sudoku

1	9	7	2	6	4	5	3	8
4	2	6	5	3	8	1	7	9
8	3	5	1	7	9	4	6	2
5	7	1	3	9	2	8	4	6
3	4	9	8	5	6	2	1	7
2	6	8	4	1	7	3	9	5
9	5	4	6	8	3	7	2	1
7	8	3	9	2	1	6	5	4
6	1	2	7	4	5	9	8	3

Intermediate Sudoku

3	5	9	6	4	1	8	7	2
1	2	4	8	7	9	5	6	3
6	7	8	5	3	2	9	1	4
9	3	5	7	1	4	6	2	8
4	1	6	3	2	8	7	9	5
7	8	2	9	6	5	4	3	1
5	9	3	1	8	7	2	4	6
2	6	7	4	5	3	1	8	9
8	4	1	2	9	6	3	5	7

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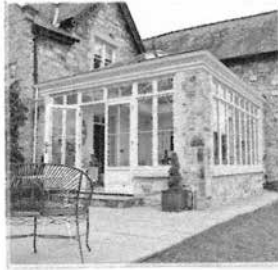
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Kington Bus Services

Kington<> Knighton

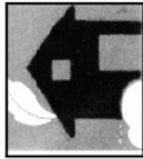
	41	41	41	41	41	41
	M>F	M>Sa	M>Sa	M>Sa	M>Sa	M>Sa
Kington Mill St	06:10	08:20	10:10	12:10	15:20	17:30
Titiley	06:18	08:28	10:19	12:19	15:19	17:39
Knighton Bus Station	06:40	-	10:48	12:45	15:55	18:05
Knighton Library		08:53	10:54	12:47	15:57	-

	41	41	41	41	41	41
	M>F	M>Sa	M>Sa	M>Sa	M>Sa	M>Sa
Knighton Offa's Dyke	06:38	09:07	11:09	13:03	16:13	18:03
Knighton Bus Staion	06:42	09:11	11:13	13:07	16:17	18:07
Titiley	07:04	09:35	11:35	13:34	16:39	18:27
Kington Mill St	07:14	09:45	11:45	13:44	16:49	18:37

Knighton<> Leominster

	95	95
Tues and Fri only	T+F	T+F
Knighton Bus Staion	09:10	13:30
Kington Mill St	09:46	13:35
Leominster Bus Station	10:31	14:23
Leominster Bus Station	10:36	14:57

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Hereford<>Kington<>Landrindod Wells

Monday to Sunday

Llandrindod Wells Railway Station Crossgates Kington. Mill St arr	461 M>F	461 C	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa
		06:38		09:00		11:08	12:08		13:08	14:08		15:50	16:00	16:11	16:46	17:10	17:37	18:50	
		06:44		09:06		11:14	12:14		13:14	14:14		15:53	16:11	16:46	17:10	17:37	18:56		
		07:13		09:45		11:45	12:45		13:45	14:45		15:55	16:58	18:07	18:22	18:59	20:24	20:52	21:48
Kington, Mill St dep Hereford Old Market Hereford Station	06:40		07:20	08:50	09:50	10:50	11:50	12:50	13:50	14:50	15:50	16:58	17:10	18:02	18:58	19:37	20:24	20:52	21:48
	07:32		08:30	09:47	10:53	11:47	12:47	13:46	14:47	15:47	16:49	17:35	18:06	18:41	19:20	20:05	20:52	21:48	
	07:37		08:35	09:52	10:58	11:52	12:52	13:55	14:52	15:52	16:55	17:41	18:12	18:47	19:26	20:11	20:58	21:45	
	461 M>Sa	461 M>F	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa
Hereford Station Hereford Mayford Kington Mill St arr		07:38	09:00	10:00	11:00	12:00	13:00	14:00	15:00	16:00	17:00	18:00	19:00	20:00	21:00	22:00	23:00	24:00	25:00
		07:42	09:07	10:07	11:07	12:07	13:07	14:07	15:07	16:07	17:07	18:07	19:07	20:07	21:07	22:07	23:07	24:07	25:07
		08:45	10:05	11:10	12:05	13:05	14:05	15:05	16:05	17:05	18:05	19:05	20:05	21:05	22:05	23:05	24:05	25:05	26:05
			10:10	11:10	12:10	13:10	14:10	15:10	16:10	17:10	18:10	19:10	20:10	21:10	22:10	23:10	24:10	25:10	26:10
Kington Mill St dep Crossgates Llandrindod Wells Station	07:50		10:10	11:10	12:10	13:10	14:10	15:10	16:10	17:10	18:10	19:10	20:10	21:10	22:10	23:10	24:10	25:10	26:10
	08:21		10:41	11:41	12:41	13:41	14:41	15:41	16:41	17:41	18:41	19:41	20:41	21:41	22:41	23:41	24:41	25:41	26:41
	08:39		10:47	11:47	12:55	13:47	14:47	15:47	16:55	17:52h	18:12	18:47	19:26	20:11	20:58	21:45	22:32	23:19	24:06

Key:

Monday to Saturday

Sundays only

C Operates Hereford College days only

School holidays $M > F$

School holidays + Sat

Please verify with Sargeants for the most up to date timings and if Sunday buses are running on the route you require.

Forthcoming events

<i>February</i>	<i>Time</i>	<i>Event</i>	<i>Venue & Contact</i>
Sun 1 st	6.00pm	Prayer & Praise Evening	St Mary's, Kingston
Mon 2 nd	12.30 – 4.00pm	Kington Zero Waste	Parish Hall
<i>Repeated weekly</i>			
Tues 3 rd	9.15 – 10.45	Stay & Play Babies and Toddlers	Parish Hall
Tues 3 rd	7.00pm	Beetle Drive	Parish Hall
Fri 6 th	10am - 12pm	Kington Zero Waste	Parish Hall
<i>Repeated weekly</i>			
Tues 10 th	9.15 – 10.45	Stay & Play Babies and Toddlers	Parish Hall
Tues 17 th	1.30 – 4.00pm	Pancakes Galore Holiday Club Booking required. £5.00 per child Legoclub.kington@gmail.com	07746 382481 St Mary's, Kingston
Wed 18 th	3.30pm	Lego Club	St Mary's, Kingston
Wed 18 th	7.00pm	Ash Wed Holy Communion with Ashing	St Mary's, Kingston
Thurs 19 th – Sat 21 st	7.30/2.30pm	Kington Operatic Panto: Sleeping Beauty www.kingtonoperatic.co.uk	Lady Hawkins School
Tues 24 th	9.15 – 10.45	Stay & Play Babies and Toddlers	Parish Hall
Sat 28 th	7.30pm	Quiz Night	Huntington Village Hall

FOR DETAILS OF CHURCH SERVICES PLEASE SEE KINGTON PARISHES PAGE 6

Plus plenty of Kington community events at The Oxford Arms, The Old Picture House, Kington Community Choir (Thursdays at The Burton).

You can also find details of many cultural events and activities in Broad Sheep: www.broadsheep.com

*If you would like a community event publicised in the Diary please contact:
Rev.Paul.C.Roberts@gmail.com*

If you or a loved one are unable to make the services at St Mary's but would appreciate prayers or Communion by extension at home, please contact Phillippa (the Curate).

Please note submission change below

MATERIAL FOR THE MARCH 2026 PARISH NEWS

by **1st February 2026**

Please send by email (maximum 500 words) to:

pn.kingtonparishes@gmail.com